

On-Site Sign-In Backup Plan — Quick Reference

Keep this open on your phone during installs. If a customer's Microsoft sign-in shows a "phishing attempt" warning or gets stuck on a blank/wrong page, this is the fix — same one that worked twice today.

Present it calmly as a normal part of setup, not an error: "Microsoft has a security setting that sometimes needs a quick one-time adjustment for this kind of sign-in — takes about a minute."

The fix

You drive this — open it on your own device or theirs, walk through it yourself, don't hand them a confusing screen.

Go to portal.azure.com

Sign in with the customer's Microsoft account (the one they use for OneDrive)

If asked to set up multi-factor authentication first — this is normal and expected, just follow the prompts (usually a phone number for a text code, quickest option)

In the search bar at the top, type "Microsoft Entra ID" and click it

In the left sidebar, click "Properties"

Find "Manage security defaults"

If it shows On, toggle it to Off

It may ask for a reason — pick anything close to "device sign-in" or just select "Other"

Click Save

Go back to the CastBoard sign-in screen and try again — should work cleanly now

If the customer asks "Is this safe?" or "Why do we need to change this?"

Honest, simple answer:

"Yes, completely safe. This app only reads your OneDrive files to show them on the screen — it can't delete, change, or share anything, and it doesn't touch anything else on your Microsoft account. The setting we're adjusting isn't 'turning off security' — it's one specific, narrow thing: Microsoft recently started blocking a particular sign-in method because scammers found a way to trick people into approving a stranger's login using it. That's not what's happening here — we're just switching this device to a sign-in method that isn't affected by that. Your password and everything else on your account stays exactly as protected as it was before."

This is accurate, not just reassuring — CastBoard only ever requests read-only access to OneDrive files, nothing broader.

If it works on the first try (no warning at all)

Great — nothing to do, skip all of the above entirely.

One thing to reassure the customer, if asked

This doesn't weaken their account's real security — it only affects this one specific sign-in style. Their password and account otherwise work exactly the same as before.